



NOG Quarterly Meeting

Monday, February 13th at 7 pm

Plymouth Place

4111 Ingersoll

Guest Speakers:

Larry Siegel

Chim Cheree House of Fireplaces

Larry Siegal, Owner of Chim Cheree, will give a presentation on historic restoration, maintenance, and safety issues related to existing and new fire places. Chim Chim Cheree House of Fireplaces is located at 534 35th Street, Des Moines, Iowa.

James Jacobsen History Pays!

Jim Jacobson will give an update on the Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey currently underway between 39th and 42nd St. and between Grand Ave. and Center St.

TAKE A TRIP THROUGH HISTORY



Photo credit: Earl Short, founder Des Moines Streetcar Friends. Woman hailing streetcar, 28th & Ingersoll, 1937.

"Take a Trip Through History: An Exhibit of Images Since 1879," presented by the North of Grand Neighborhood, Feb. 13th-March 18th, at Zanzibar's Coffee Adventure, located at 2723 Ingersoll Ave. Hours: Monday-Thursday 6:30am-8pm; Friday-Saturday 6:30am-9pm, and Sunday 8am-6pm.

You're invited to a reception, 3 to 5 p.m. Feb. 19th, at Zanzibar's, with brief talk at 4 p.m. by architectural historian Jim Jacobsen, consultant for the "Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey."

This project is supported in part by the State Historical Society of Iowa, Historical Resource Development Program, Polk County Community Betterment Grant program, the City of Des Moines, many area businesses, volunteers, and residents of the North of Grand neighborhood.

Thank you for your support!

OUR MISSION

The neighborhood association's mission is to ensure that existing and projected infrastructure systems are managed or developed so they enhance the physical, visual and spatial qualities of the neighborhood — promoting a healthy climate for area businesses, and public and private properties.

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ALICE RODINE AWARDS

The North of Grand Neighborhood Association nominates the following individuals for the Des Moines Neighbors Alice Rodine awards for their outstanding volunteer service:



Kyle Larson (left) and Phil Poorman (right)

A city of Des Moines employee since 1979, Philip "Phil" R. Poorman, is nominated for his support and assistance of the historic survey projects in the North of Grand and Drake neighborhoods. From 1979 to 2005, Phil worked as an Assistant City Planner, and from 1988 to 1999 was staff to the Historic District Commission. He was a Site Plan and Subdivision Plan Reviewer for all projects in the City from 1996-2005. Phil has met with and made numerous presentations to neighborhoods about city projects from 1979-1996. Phil also wrote and was awarded numerous grants for recreation trails and transportation projects in the City. From 1988 to 2005, Phil processed, reviewed, and sent all tax abatement applications to City Council for approval. He was also instrumental in having the City designated a Bike Friendly Community for the first time in the late 1980's. Since 2005, Phil has served as a Development Zoning Inspector, and is responsible to enforce site plan, zoning, landscaping, sound, transient merchant, and sign requirements, review building permit applications for compliance with zoning requirements, provide citizens with zoning information about city requirements for individual projects, and has processed, reviewed, and sent all tax abatement applications to City Council for approval.

Kyle Larson, City Planner

Kyle began his career with the City of Des Moines in 2005, when he was hired as a City Planner in the Neighborhood Development Division of the Community Development Department. During his time with the City, Kyle has led a number of neighborhood planning and revitalization efforts including the Drake and Waterbury Neighborhood Plans, the redevelopment of Forest Avenue, and various streetscape enhancement projects around Des Moines. He is also a member of the City's Sustainability Team that has been tasked with advancing Des Moines as a sustainable, green community. In 2012, Kyle is looking forward to working with the Lower Beaver Neighborhood on the development of their neighborhood plan, helping the North of Grand Neighborhood wrap-up their historic survey, as well as the assisting the Beaverdale Neighborhood on their ongoing streetscape project. Away from the office, Kyle enjoys spending time with his wife, Amanda, and their two children, Ava (3) and Nolan (1). Originally from Council Bluffs, Kyle attended Iowa State University and graduated in 2002 with a degree in Community and Regional Planning.

Karen Hanley of West Des Moines has volunteered dozens of hours for the historic survey research projects in the North of Grand and Drake neighborhoods. She graduated from Roosevelt High School, and obtained her undergraduate degree from Wichita State University. In 2011, she retired from Vocational Rehabilitation. Karen has a long-time interest in historical architecture, particularly Frank Lloyd Wright architecture. She collects newspaper and other print documentation of buildings and events in the Des Moines area. She also is a postcard collector and an avid genealogist. Karen also volunteers for the Altoona Area Historical Society, and participates in the Des Moines Historical Society and the Iowa Genealogical Society.

Thanks to Linda Fritz, who has been one of our neighborhood mail carriers for about seven years. Undeterred by rain, sleet or snow, she delivers the mail, Linda also plays an important role by keeping an eye out for suspicious-looking characters in the neighborhood. Thanks to these dedicated U.S. Postal Service employees for being the eyes and ears of our community.



Karen Hanley



Linda Fritz

A SPECIAL THANK YOU

Two Drake University history student interns, Heather Reading and Rachael Snell, under the direction of Dr. Amahia Mallea, are also working with resident volunteers and Jim Jacobsen on North of Grand's Greenwood Park Plat Historic Survey. They are contributing their research skills to gather documents about the people, infrastructure, businesses and churches of early Des Moines. NOG appreciates the support of Drake University!

Drake
UNIVERSITY

INGERSOLL/GRAND CORRIDOR MASTER PLANNING INITIATIVE MOVES FORWARD

In November, a public meeting regarding the master plan for the Ingersoll and Grand corridors was held at the Arthur Davis Room at the Greater Des Moines Partnership Building downtown. Over 50 people attended the meeting, including representation from each of the 10 impacted neighborhoods.

A brief presentation was given by Ted Irvine and covered the following topics;

- Create Master Plan that include 3 components
 - Urban Renewal Plan-Technical support for TIF
 - Concept Plan for District- Includes Financial and growth targets
 - Engineering, Construction and Bidding Plans
- Council Adopts the Plans in April 2012
- Coordinate Plans with DART for Construction Plans and Timing 2014-2015 Target Complete
- Attract and Grow Tax Increment
- Create Ongoing Support Organization- e.g. DCA
- Streetscape is the Priority 43rd-15th
- Planning for a Larger District (Grand) Increases our Priority
- Inclusive Approach with Neighbors, Businesses and Organizations Increases our Likelihood of Success

After the presentation, a workshop was facilitated by Glen Lyons of the Downtown Community Alliance. The discussion centered on the following questions for each street;

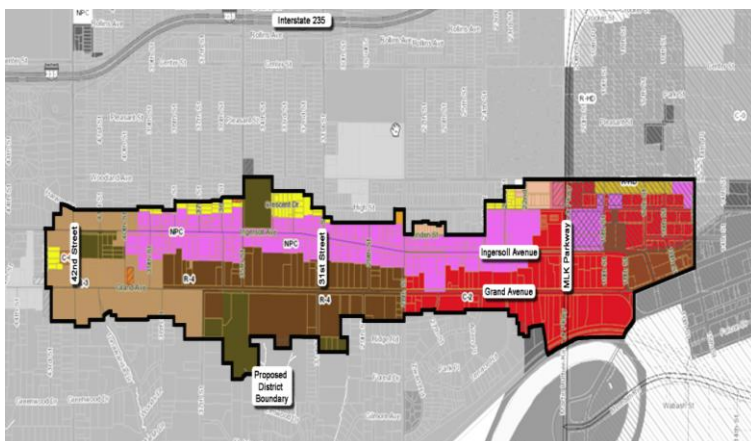
- What do you like most about Ingersoll/Grand?
- What do you like least about Ingersoll/Grand?
- If you could change one thing, what would it be?

After the meeting those interested in participating further were invited to join one of the following committees.

- Transportation
- Public Art
- Grand Ave. Streetscape
- Land use, Sustainability, and Environment
- Marketing and Communication

In the time since the November 30th Meeting, strategic planning and committee meetings have been held a Des Moines University and elsewhere with the goal of having a plan in place for City Council Approval in April 2012. For additional information please contact Ted Irvine

irvine.ingersoll@gmail.com or Matt Coen mcoen@studiocoenarch.com.



Proposed TIF District; provided by Simonson and Associates Architects, LLC.

DART – BUS RAPID TRANSIT: PROPOSED ROUTE 60

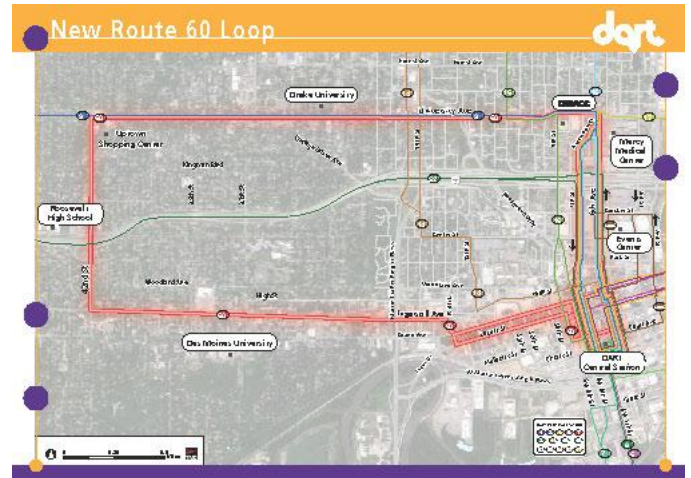


IMAGE AND STORY CREDIT: Des Moines Area Transit (DART)

The proposal for developing “bus-rapid transit” along portions of University and Ingersoll Avenues in Des Moines was the subject of three open houses held on for Thursday, Jan. 26.

Bus-rapid transit – often described as rail-like service that is delivered with buses – can include many features to improve the level of service along a bus route. The Des Moines Area Regional Transit Authority is wrapping up an investment study on the possibility of developing bus-rapid transit on a planned new Route 60 loop route.

Starting next year, Route 60 will provide frequent service in both directions on Ingersoll and University Avenues between downtown Des Moines and 42nd Street. These established transit corridors feature high-density residential neighborhoods and an abundance of destinations including two medical centers, three institutions of higher learning, multiple shopping districts and employment centers, and many other services.

As part of the investment study, DART is proposing to build bus stations along the route with real-time arrival and departure information, to offer 10-minute service at peak usage, to use technology to change stoplights and accelerate travel times, and to develop separate branding for the service. This investment study is called an “Alternatives Analysis,” a first, critical step in qualifying for federal funding through the Very Small Starts program of the Federal Transit Administration. DART is asking the public for feedback on its proposal.

More information about bus-rapid transit and the investment study is available online at www.ridedart.com/busrapid-transit-study.cfm. The Des Moines Area Regional Transit Authority is the public transportation provider that serves Polk County. DART operates a family of transportation services that makes getting around the Greater Des Moines area easier and more convenient. For more information about DART services, schedules, route changes, or directions to the nearest DART stop, visit our website at www.ridedart.com or call 515.283.8100.



Plymouth Place provides quality housing for individuals aged 62 and above with low or moderate incomes. Newly renovated apartments will be opening soon, for more information call 274-0438

NOG Membership

In efforts to streamline the process of how North of Grand memberships are renewed - We are switching to sending out a paper invoice in February to everyone. The amount due will be your dues for the calendar year of 2012. If you have any questions - please contact Kimberly Hansen at 279-2684.

2012 Dues:

General Membership is open to everyone.

Voting members must live, work, rent, or own property within the NOG boundaries

Individual:	\$12 per year
Household:	\$22 per year
Business:	\$30 per year
Patron:	\$50 per year

North of Grand Neighborhood Association
P.O. Box 12027
Des Moines, IA 50312

2012 Membership Invoices

To be mailed week of Feb. 13th

We value your support in 2012!



Neighborhood Based Service Delivery

If you have concerns about a problem in your neighborhood or have a question regarding city services and you're not sure who to call, please contact the following individuals: **Des Moines Police Dept. Sgt. Vince Valdez or City Code Enforcement Inspector Ed Leedom 283-4183.**

North of Grand Neighborhood Association Board of Directors

- **President:** Kimberly Hansen 279-2684
kimberlymhansen@aol.com
- **Vice President:** Mark Siegfried 255-7667
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- **Treasurer:** Matt Braafhart 279-6945
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- **At Large:** Justin Gross 865-1468
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www.northofgrandneighborhood.org

Find us on FACEBOOK: North of Grand DSM

Hope to see you at our meeting on February 13th

PLEASE STOP IN WHEN YOUR GROUP MEETS AT PLYMOUTH CHURCH!

We're brewing more than just **COFFEE!**



PLYMOUTH GROUNDS – now open in the southwest corner of Plymouth Church, near Waveland Hall – is staffed by intellectually disabled students from Ruby Van Meter School. When you stop in for coffee or a pastry, students have the opportunity to practice academic, social and work skills that they have learned in the classroom and apply them to the real world. Plymouth Church volunteers work side-by-side with them in the not-for-profit coffee shop.

While your experience at Plymouth Grounds may take a little longer than at a traditional coffee shop, you have the satisfaction of knowing you are helping these students brew more than just coffee!

Featuring a small menu of coffee drinks, hot and cold beverages, and pastries.

NOW OPEN!
8:30 A.M.-NOON, M-F



Plymouth GRUNDS COFFEE SHOP

Plymouth Church | 4126 Ingersoll Ave. | M-F 8:30 a.m.-Noon